

geoffadwynedit

Hello, Alden Altonay here. Welcome to Media Queen TV. I have a fantastic guest today, someone I've known for a very long time.

The amazing Jeff Harrison. He's extraordinary. He's been in the media for 44 years.

He doesn't even look 44 years old. He's been for so long. Such a big history this guy has coming to us all the way from Amsterdam.

How are you, Jeff? Hi, I'm William. Great to talk to you from Amsterdam in the Netherlands. Europe calling and they say in Eurovision.

And it was a great Eurovision this year, by the way, from Rotterdam. And I think everyone, including me, because I've been watching Eurovision for 50 years. 50 years I've been watching Eurovision and since the 60s.

I must say that the presentation this year, and I think everyone would agree in Australia, was absolutely fantastic. The presentation of Eurovision has really gone to another level this year. Great stuff.

And looking forward to Australia being back in again next year as well. Yes, yes, I love the Eurovision Song Contest. We used to watch it as kids religiously every year and I absolutely love it.

And I'm sure there are many benefits to being in Europe right now as much as the culture. It must be very exciting living over there. And we'll get into that a little bit more.

I want to share a little bit of your background with people who don't know you before we get into the crux of this interview. And we do have a hot topic here tonight or today for you. It's noon over there in Amsterdam right now and it is 8 p.m. here on the Gold Coast in Australia.

We're talking about streaming media, the future of global broadcasting today. Such a hot topic and something that Jeff has a hell of a lot of experience in. Now, Jeff and I actually met 20 odd years ago when I was a journalist at The Sun Newspapers and Betty Harrison, your gorgeous mother.

She came to me with stories about local politics that she was very involved in at the time. And she said, you have to meet my son. And this is how we connected.

And at the time you were doing media and you were doing magic. You were known for Jeff Diamond doing your magic around the Gold Coast. A sleight of hand magic, which is a really tricky thing to do.

And you're so good at it. And, you know, you just had such an infectious personality. And we've just stayed friends and gone through so many journeys together.

We've worked together since then and stayed in touch. It's been an amazing journey. So a little bit of your background.

But those who don't know you, Jeff actually started in radio with 2UW Sydney as a 16 year old in 1977. I was actually three at the time then. Rolls included announcer, chief of news, foreign correspondent, radio TV production, editing and voice over.

Some other things about Jeff is he is going back here. He's also now is a freelance journalist. He is a voice over artist, published travel writer, professional journalist, video producer, TV channel owner, who is the CEO and founder of Ski TV nowadays.

He's an accredited winter sports journalist for all sports, covered two winter Olympics, the Calgary in 1988 and Norway in 1994 for Australian national radio networks. He actually owns Ski TV Limited UK, which owns a satellite broadcasting license for Sky TV UK and an OTT. We'll talk about OTT and OTT delivered network of Sky TV's snow and ski related online TV channels.

He's also currently creating Europe's own ski TV channel. He's launched ski TV on networks such as ROKU Network in USA, Amazon Firestick UK Europe and Ski TV now is also launched on SportsTribal.com to various major networks actually in April as of April this year and around the world such as Vision, 247, Zumo, Firework, Plex, Samsung TV, LG TV, Panasonic TV networks and later he'll be expanding these channels to all ski related countries in the world. So this will be the equivalent of the golf channel in the US, which is absolutely huge.

And the list goes on. You've done so much. You've worked with BBC Radio in London for 15 years, 10 years as an Australian radio correspondent for BBC Radio 5 Live, former news director at 3UZ Radio in Melbourne, Australia on Jack Blackmon, Ian Covershow, news reader journalist Radio 3AW Melbourne and so much more.

There's just so much of your media background, Geoff. It's phenomenal what you have achieved in the media and it's such an honour and pleasure to know you all these years and to remain such great friends. Now, Geoff, my goodness, I don't know where to start with this really.

So maybe let's just start at the beginning. Can you tell us a bit about your history, about your background? How did you get into the media in the first place? Sure. Well, being old, you get to cram a lot in.

That's all I can say about all that. Yeah, you know, one good thing about getting older is you get a lot of time. But yeah, well, born in London, Irish parents to my mother, Betty and Tom, and we, you know, my fabulous family, two brothers.

And my father was working on as an electrical engineer and we worked all around the world. So by the time I arrived in Australia in early 1970s, you know, it was 74, 75 when we arrived from Australia via the United States. But my father was working on airports and that sort of thing.

And then in the United States, I was in school and I wasn't really interested. And in the UK, I wasn't really interested in anything else except radio. I was a complete radio freak.

I really wanted to get into radio since I was like 10 years old. I couldn't believe that there were guys, you know, I was listening to Radio Caroline and Radio London in London that were coming from offshore boats, you know, and coming from Radio Luxembourg. And I would listen to these radio stations under the covers in my head and think these guys are having a ball.

They're playing the best music. They're excited. It was the best music time in the early 70s.

And I think a lot of people my age will agree the early 70s, mid 70s, late 70s were some of the greatest time for music in history. And I got really amazed that these people could be sitting there playing this great music being this choppy and getting paid for it. And I thought to myself, that's what I want to do.

This is what I want to do. I want to be on the radio. I don't want to listen to radio.

I want to be a radio announcer. So when I got to Australia, I was in school about 15, 16 years old and I hated school and I had everything about it except I wanted to be radio. So I I pestered actually to UW was in Kent Street in Sydney and I actually went into Kent Street to get a job.

The lady was there and you could just walk in off the street, basically. And the lady there said, no, we don't have any jobs at the moment for 16 year old. Sorry about that.

See you later. So I'd come in the following week and I said, hi, I was just in the area and I wasn't just in the area because I had to travel by train from Fairfield, which is a hell of a trip. And I went in every single week for five weeks.

And she said, listen, we do have a job for you now because you're not going to stop coming in, are you? And I said, no, I'm not. This is this is the number one station in Sydney. I listen to it all the time.

Everybody does in Sydney because John Laws was there. And she said, well, we do have an opening for a panel operator cartridge kit to record tapes onto cartridges because that's what the way radio was worked then in the studios. And she said, go up in the lift with half of the lift driver because to UW had its own lift driver called Arthur, which it was just there to drive the lift.

Went up to the fourth floor, saw Bill Gates, who was who was a very, very fun. Not not the computer Bill Gates, but radio Bill Gates, who was a very brief aims radio announcer in his time. But he was actually program director of UW at the time.

And I'm sitting there in his office as a 16 year old, you know, really nervous. And I said, he said, and by the way, Bill Gates discovered the Bee Gees. He was the Bee Gees first manager and the Bee Gees named after his initials, Bee Gees, Bill Gates.

That's how they thought up the name. And so he said, yeah. So he said to me, hey, listen, so I hear you've got a bit of radio experience.

And I said, yeah, because I actually was in radio and TV class in my school in America. And he said, oh, good. Well, come down and I'll show you the studio.

And if you can if you think you can run the panel, which is the, you know, audio panel back then, which is a 12 channel mixer. And he said, you do have experience running all of this, don't you? And I said, of course I do. You know, not anything.

Are you kidding me? I didn't know anything about it. It was huge. They're like walking into a 64 channel recording studio.

And I said, of course I can run this, Bill. Of course, like I said, oh, can you start on Monday then? I said, sure. So the first week I actually botched everything.

And the guy who was my boss said, you have no idea what you're doing, do you? I said, no, I don't. I just said all this stuff to get this job. I have no idea.

So he said, all right, we'll sit down and train you for a week. We didn't expect to do this, but I spent a year there. And I ended up becoming John Law's panel operator and, you know, working with all the big names at the station, which was Paulie Austin and, you know, Keith McGowan and John and Malcolm T. Elliott.

And I was working closely with all of them because I would prepare all their cartridges for their shows and their recorded advertisements, which they do. So so that was an incredible year. And then and then I thought to myself, do I want to spend my time here being off there? I want to be on air.

And I applied for a job at 17 with 4NA Nambour in Queensland, which is just up on the Sunshine Coast. And they had a job going for an announcer. And I applied for that job and I got the job and had to leave Sydney and a bit of a culture shock going from the Bright Life of Sydney where I was also DJing in nightclubs at 16 and and hit Nambour, which was a tiny little town of like, you know, a thousand people.

So it's a bit of a culture shock from the Bright Life of Sydney to this tiny little place, you know, where I'm on air in the evening, you know, central midnight to virtually nobody, but a beautiful place. And back then, in 1977, it was completely untouched. You know, the Sunshine Coast, I think we had a maroochie door.

There's one building which was Surf Air, one on the side at Maroochie Door. That was it. And there was there was Surf Air and the Surf Club.

That was it. That was the only buildings there. And, you know, I could have the whole beach to myself during the day because I had all day free, of course.

So I could go and lie on the beach and completely deserted on there and a tiny little town. And then from there went for three years in Tunchpew Row, moving around, you know, a year in each station, went from a year in Nambour, got offered a bigger job at 3DO Bendigo. And that was in 1978.

And in 1979, I joined 3KZ in Melbourne, which is a really big metropolitan radio station. I was doing overnights there at McDonald's. And then in 1980, the station Fox FM started.

And I was one of the original announcers on Fox FM for three years, the first FM stations in Australia. And since then, three years there, since then got into news, lost a bit of interest, got found by the time I was 23. I found playing music a bit boring and then became very interested in news and current affairs and did my cadetship as a journalist in 1984 in 3MP Melbourne.

And then spent two years there and then joined 3AW Melbourne's number one radio station as a journalist and went on in the mid 80s to cover a huge range of stories. And during this time, I was actually DJing every year at Falls Creek Ski Resort for a couple of weeks. And I made the huge error of asking in 1983, what's the local radio station here? And they said, we don't have a local radio station here.

It doesn't exist. There is no radio station in the ski resorts anywhere in Victoria. And I saw an opportunity there.

And during my time in between being a journalist at 3AW and 3UZ, there was a news director by the time I was 28. I decided to start my own radio station. And I said, this is what I've always wondered, why work for people.

You can own your own. So it took me eight years to get a radio license going through the government applications to get a radio license to broadcast FM. And I started the first ever FM radio station in history in the Victoria, in snowfields and in snowfields in Australia at Falls Creek and Holland in 1990 and ran that for five years.

And during that time, I also started reporting for the BBC as Australian copper summon for Radio 5 Live. And basically back in the early 2000s, I moved over to Europe and I got interested in magic as well back in 96, trained in Las Vegas, lived in Las Vegas for three months training in magic. And, you know, because radio and the media, as you know, Aldwin is very, very unstable.

You can lose your job any day at any time, no matter how good you are. So I got into magic to help me to travel around the world and be able to be a bit self sufficient wherever I went. So I did

that in the early 2000s.

I became the BBC radio and TV correspondent in Sweden covering all of Scandinavia and did that for about four or five years up until the big crash in 2008. And then since then, I've been, you know, freelancing, doing radio work also in Australia from your neck of the woods. I ran beach radio for I was involved for that 10 years in the 90s.

So it's a lot like crammed in there. And since then, in the in the noughties, I suppose 2000 from 11 up to recently, I've been running ski TV, which is an online streaming channel for the world's 100 million plus skiers and snowboarders. And that started in Australia back in 2015.

And since then, it's exploded quite a bit. And since I've moved to Europe and here full time and running ski TV across the European continent and now going into America as well. So I'm sorry if that's a bit overwhelming, but that's my whole thing in a bit of a nutshell.

Amazing, amazing, Jeff. I bet you've seen some phenomenal changes in that time. What has it been like going from back in the tape days to, you know, how the world media is now? I mean, Facebook only started in 2004, right? And now we've got half the world's population on social media, active social media users.

And it's a massive change. So what have you noticed in the world of radio, TV? What have you noticed the biggest changes have been in that time? Well, funnily enough, back in 1996, I had another idea to create a software program that and I squeezed in my degree as well in that time at Monash University. So but at that time, yeah, crazy.

So at that time, people were still transferring audio from reel to reel tape onto cartridges in radio. That's the way radio stations ran for every and you've probably seen pictures or of, you know, radio announcers with five billion tapes around them. You know, cartridge tapes that are a bit like an eight track tape.

That's that's cartridge. And that's how we run. So every cartridge contained a song or an ad, you know, a 30 second ad.

And I said, hang on, we've got computers now. You know, there must be a better way. Back then in 1996, MP3 came onto the market, compressed audio and MP3, which everyone knows now.

But back then, no one knew anything about it. It was just what is an MP3? What does it mean? And it means Moving Pictures Group, by the way, moving pictures times three. That's what it means.

And not many people know that either. So it's yeah. So and I developed a program called Radio Wolf, which allowed people to record from tape onto an MP3, and then that became a an organizer for radio stations.

So I had Radio Wolf had a hundred radio stations using my program to play out via a Windows 96 computer back then, which was the highest, the highest tech Windows 96. It's like it, you know, it was full on, you know, and it ran very, very successfully on that. And, you know, we got to all these stations across the world.

And then we had a little program called Winamp come in. Winamp, I don't know whether anyone remembers that, but Winamp came in and sort of blasted us out of the water because Winamp has huge resources. Winamp had huge, you know, marketing budgets, which went across the world.

So so that became sort of like a temporary thing that we would think we couldn't compete with that. And then, of course, everything exploded in the between 96 and 2000 for people to use computers to run their systems because I predicted in 1996. One day there's going to be streaming radio stations where people can use their own, can have their own streaming platform where they, you can, it can be old one, alternate radio.

And that is, that's come to pass now. But back in 96, no one thought that could ever be a possibility because we all thought, no, there's no way normal people can run TV or produce their own TV programs or run their own radio. So look where we are now.

Things like Zoom and things like this platform we're on now allows people to do it and not be professionals, not be radio people, not be TV people. But they are doing it now. They're creating their own media in a fantastic way.

And I applaud that because it opens up the whole world democratically for media production. And, you know, the whole thing is exploding, as you know, especially in the pandemic in the past year, people have, you know, a year and a half ago, who knew about Zoom? Zoom was like, well, what is it? What is it? It's nothing. It doesn't affect me at all.

Now the whole world is running around Zoom, you know, the whole world is doing that. And that's very, very exciting for everybody. Yes.

Well, interestingly, now there's over two million podcasts worldwide now, Jeff, and Zoom actually tripled its income during COVID. Actually, when COVID started in March, Zoom just went exponential. It went crazy.

So, you know, it's amazing. While some businesses and people have been struggling around COVID, others have been absolutely booming. And this is the thing is, if you don't embrace new technology, and if you don't constantly move with the times, you will get left behind, right? So, you know, you need to be willing to change and move with the times and get up to date with the tech.

And the tech changes so rapidly, doesn't it, Jeff? You know, having done a lot of videography work yourself as well, you know, how have you found keeping up with the changes with the

technology? Well, as you know, you're a photographer as well and a video maker. And, you know, I've got cameras that cost 3,000 to 6,000 euros. Well, dollars, I keep saying euros because I'm in Europe.

But, you know, there are phones now that you can buy \$500 that do exactly the same thing as a \$5,000 camera, broadcast camera. And we have now the stabiliser units that you can buy for, you know, \$100 or \$150. And you anyone can set themselves up now as a pretty good cinematographer if they prepared to study the lighting and get the angles right and all that kind of thing.

So that's another way that technology is completely changed the whole game. It's opened up huge amounts of creative possibilities for people who, in the past, didn't have access to those high-quality cameras. The devices, you know, where you can for under \$1,000 now, you can set yourself up as a pretty good videographer and photographer using phone technology and all that sort of thing.

The sensors in those phones are just incredible now. You know, it's amazing. But what we're talking about today, I suppose, is streaming media.

And streaming media is just exploding. And what we've got now is convergence between broadcast media and streaming media. The old way of doing it was to, if you wanted to create a television channel, you had to have millions and millions of dollars.

You had to, you know, get a license from the federal government. You had to, you know, you're talking Kerry Packer time here of billions that you had to put behind this. And now with the new technology, with things like connected television, and that's why Ski TV is going so well now, because we have the ability to jump on the platforms and deliver our service to hundreds of millions of people around the world without all the massive expense.

It's still expensive. It's still, you have to play our providers. It costs a few thousand a month.

You have to have, you know, it's, but it's nowhere near what it used to be. The only thing we had in the past was satellite delivered. And we're all moving now away from satellite to IP TV, which is internet protocol television.

And the great thing is that practically every television you buy now is a connected TV. You know, you'd be absolutely crazy not to buy a TV that is connected now. And that those TVs come with bundles of channels already preloaded into the TV itself.

And, you know, there's there's a great way of doing that for us on those platforms to reach those hundreds of millions of people around the world without all the massive expense. And that's what TV is doing now. We're we're part of the new breed of TV channels that just stream pretty much onto major platforms around the world.

And we have hundreds of content providers who give us their content, people like Red Bull and North Face and Atomic and all sorts of other people give us their content and we make our own content. So it's a combination of both. And you can see all that at ski TV TV, free online.

It's all free to watch. And this is another thing. You don't have to subscribe to watch our service.

You can just whack us onto your connected TV at home. And we're there and increasingly on major platforms as well. Wow.

Very cool. And we've got the Olympic Games apparently coming to the Gold Coast. I've just heard coming here.

I just heard that. I think someone said 2023 or something. Oh, that's interesting.

Yeah. Coming here. Probably because Gold Coast hasn't been that affected by covid.

So maybe they're thinking it's one of the safest places in the world to do something like this. So so we'll say you had a great Commonwealth Games there. Commonwealth Games.

We did a couple of years ago. Yeah, we did. We had a great Commonwealth Games here.

So interesting times ahead with that. So what about your history with skiing? Were you always a skier as a young kid or what got you into skiing? No, not really. Well, well, the way I got into skiing was in 1983, I was working at Fox FM as an announcer.

And I had four or five weeks holiday built up. And a friend of mine in Melbourne who worked for 3AW called David Mann, a very, very famous guy in Melbourne. If anyone's from Melbourne, they all know David Mann from 3AW is an absolute legend.

He rang me up and he said, Jeff, what are you doing for the next few weeks? And I said, well, I'm just on holiday in Melbourne. I'm not doing anything. I'm just hanging around.

He said, listen, I heard you DJ as a part time thing, which I was then. And he said, and we were doing all that vinyl, of course, the first time around, we weren't cool retro. We were just that was it.

You had a crate full of records, you know. And that was when we hated it. But now it's all cool hipster, you know.

But back then it was like, oh, my God, we had no choices. We just had to play all the records and buy all the records to play them. And he said, look, I've got some friends of mine who own a pub up at Falls Creek in Victoria, which is a great ski resort.

And they said they're looking for a DJ for the next few weeks. And would you like to go up and DJ and all you have to do is play records between 10 p.m. and 1 a.m. And that's it. And you get paid and you get free accommodation and you get free food and free drinks.

And I said, well, I mean, I mean, I had no idea about skiing, never been to a ski resort. And and got up there and decided one day, well, I've got all day free. I might as well learn how to ski, which was, you know, and just started and then I absolutely fell in love with it.

I just couldn't believe it. And I was going back to the man for a few years after that. I just got completely enamored.

And that's where I got the idea for a snow radio station, which I started up in 1990 Snow FM. And yeah, but that's how it started in skiing for me. And I've been hooked ever since.

So I've been skiing pretty much full on for the load. And I actually ended up living at the resorts running ski TV for five years. So I'd ski every day for three or four months, you know, in a season where a lot of people only get to do it for a weekend or a week.

I was living in the resorts, Mount Paula and Falls Creek and Mount Hoffman running, you know, employing five people as my announcers. And we were doing everything by hand. It was all manual.

There were no computers back then in 1990. It was, yeah, but you couldn't run music on them or anything like that. They were just glorified spreadsheets, you know, glorifying.

Your program was either a game of Pong, you know, or a word processor. And that was it. And they cost about five grand for a computer, which in today's money is about fifteen thousand dollars, you know.

So yeah, so there was no way. So we were all just playing music up there, you know, tuning the discs at our, you know, makeshift studios at the ski resorts, which is an incredible time. Absolutely incredible to do that.

And yeah, we and that's how I got involved in skiing. I've been hooked ever since. And that's how ski TV came about from those days.

Yeah. Amazing. I bet you got up to all sorts of mischief up there, Jeff.

I can just imagine what happened in those days. Oh, yes. Yes.

Well, well, there's a lot of things that happened in the 80s and 90s on the ski resorts that you that you don't know about party wise. And I was a lot younger then. And it got to the point where it actually got to the point where I had to get counseling for alcohol abuse.

I had to because I had absolutely no shame in that. And I think if anyone's in that position, do it because as you can imagine, when when you're running a radio station at a ski resort, everybody wants to be your friend. Everybody wants to hang out with you.

And these people who come up to the ski resort, they're on full on holidays. They are there to party. They're there to ski and party.

There's only two things going on there. And it's very hard to say to these people. No, I don't want to party with you.

Absolutely not. I think you're boring. Get out of my, you know, it's no.

It's like we're all skiing. We hit the athlete ski at four o'clock and then it goes into the night. And that's day after day after day for months or months.

That's the way it is. And around about 1992, 93, I hit the wall. I just couldn't.

I was having pains in my liver. I was having all sorts of. And I actually went to a counselor with Melbourne and he said, Jeff, you're an alcoholic.

You are partying way too much and you're hitting the booze way too much for your health. So I went through a three month program of detox and I went through and since then, ever since then, I've become extremely careful about my alcohol consumption. And if I do, I'm not completely teetotal, but I'm extremely aware of working in this industry too.

You have to be on time. You have to be together. And I see alcohol now as a bit of an enemy.

You know, I have to really keep it under control because it's very easy for it to get away with you. And it's been good. I'm so grateful for that.

I'm so grateful for going through that. You know, that negative time because if I kept going on the track I was going, I probably wouldn't be here today. And there's a lot of people in the industry, in media who realize that.

And because it's so easy in the media, you know, you can there's always events. There's always three parties. As you know, you know, you know yourself, you get invited to a lot of stuff because of your position in media.

And there's a lot of people who let it get on top of them. And I'm grateful that I got the counseling and decided to go in another direction and another path. Yeah, I can really relate to that.

Actually, in 92 to 94, I was doing a media degree at the University of Canberra. And up until that point, I actually went through a really dark period in my teenage years in Sydney where I was drinking a lot and smoking a lot and doing drugs and all sorts of stuff. I was very self-destructive, very angry with the world and didn't feel I could really change it in a big way until I found the media.

And the media was a great outlet for me to help express things that I saw that angered me or sad

of me in some way. I wrote stories about duck shooting. I couldn't believe people were shooting ducks for fun.

I wrote about the environment, about recycling, about female circumcision, about battery farming of chickens. Whatever I saw that angered me or sad of me in some way, I would write about back in those days in the university newspaper. And I actually applied for that job three times before I got it so I can really relate to your persistence as a six-year-old.

Yeah, yeah. You've got to be persistent, right? You've got to have this thing about you. And as a journalist, and having since then been an entertainment reporter for years and getting invited to so many VIP parties, I ended up, after that, actually drinking a hell of a lot at a lot of parties.

And yeah, you get to the point where if you keep going like that, you will burn out. And this is why they actually say there's a five-year burnout with journalists because a lot of them are just so stressed off. Like, it's the constant deadlines.

And the way they release their stress is by drinking often. And, you know, it can become a really bad habit, I guess, that, you know, you often you're drinking. You don't even realize how much you're drinking.

And, you know, your glasses keep getting topped up all the time at these VIP parties. And, you know, next thing you know, you know, it's just not a pretty sight. That's true.

But we live and learn. And, you know, I know a few journalists actually that have died in their early 60s that, you know, because it was very common for journalists to go to the pub on a Friday night. And they were big smokers back then, big drinkers.

And, you know, I know a few guys died of cancer. Are you kidding? It was every single afternoon in the...actually, when I was at 3AW in the newsroom, they were an inch, which I'm sure is familiar to a lot of people. I mean, he would finish his show at nine o'clock and then hit the booze.

He would be on it and with his team, you know, because they'd be working. Oh, sorry. He was on nine till 12 on 3AW.

So as soon as 12 o'clock hits, they are on the booze. And I was invited to a couple of those things because I contributed quite a bit to his show, you know, doing special reports and things. And I couldn't handle it because they would just they would get off air at 12 and it was a team of about people.

And they'd sit in three in their offices and 3AW and all the full strength V.B.'s would come out and the Scotch and everything. And that was every single day. Right.

And that was really normal for journalists to do that. That's just being a tough rock. You know, we can do all these crazy stories.

And and quite frankly, I don't blame them in a way because some of the stories that you're covering as a journalist really hit hard. I mean, you know, I'll give you a couple of instances with me. One instance was I was at the I was at night in a newsroom and I get a call that something was happening in Hoddle Street in 1987.

Right. Hoddle Street, which turned into the Hoddle Street massacre. And I went up there in the news car to see what was going on because that was my job at that time.

And there I was under the news car being shot at by Julian Knight, the mass murderer. So that sort of thing is just every day work, every day work, you know, and I stayed there for the next 24 hours in the news car. No sleep.

I went, you know, from being shot at to doing live reports across Australia from the news car, which was parked right across the road, looking at all the dead bodies, looking at all the people who'd been killed and injured there and and having to report it every hour for the next 24 hours. And that sort of thing really hits you mentally. It hits you not so much at the time because you don't have time to think about it at that time because you've got a job to do.

People are relying back back at the station and and they want to the news and and you get that kind of experience and it hits you probably three months. You realize you realize it's and it wasn't diagnosed back then in the mid 80s PTSD. It wasn't, you know, post-traumatic stress syndrome.

No one even realized it existed. And when you go through those kind of experiences as a journalist where you're right on the front line, it can be extremely, extremely damaging to your mental health. And a lot of people use alcohol and including myself to cover that up, you know, to say, oh, it wasn't that bad.

It wasn't. Whereas most people, even police officers these days, if they go through any kind of event like that, they were off work for two years, you know, on complete full day and rehabilitation. We didn't have any of that back in the 80s.

That didn't exist for any of us. And it didn't exist for police. It didn't.

It was all just just get on with it. You know, yes, sure, you were shot at by a mass murderer, but just get on with it. You know, it's not no big deal.

What kind of a person are you when you can't just brush that off? And that just wouldn't be allowed these days. It wouldn't be allowed to happen. You know, but that's a good one of the big reasons why a lot of people drank back then as well.

Yes. Yes, that's true. That's true.

And it was a very stressful job. It's very stressful meeting deadlines, yet alone turning up at situations which are potentially life-threatening for you. I mean, I remember when I was working

at the Queensland Times in Ipswich and I ended up at an accident scene before the ambulance and before the police got there.

It was an elderly couple in a car that had collided with a semi-trailer on the highway. And the trailer had these massive train bogies on them. The bogies had tipped and landed on this elderly couple.

And they were cocooned in the car still alive. So I turned up because we had the police scanners back then. I was there with the photographer as the journalist for the Queensland Times.

And we turned up and there's you can see an arm popping out the side of the car. And, you know, I mean, soon afterwards, the ambulance, the police got there. But, you know, to see that and then to have to report on that and to talk to the guy that was the truck driver who was obviously in shock and, you know, trying to get the details.

From people who were all in shock and all trying to deal with what had just happened. And, you know, burying it with later burying it with alcohol. And, you know, it's very, very stressful.

Post-traumatic stress disorder was not really acknowledged then. And you see this with a lot of people who come out of the army. You know, how many how many people who come from being in war or war zones or war times end up being massive drinkers and, you know, trying to bury the PTSD, you know, drama with alcohol.

It's it's it never leaves you. It never leaves you. It's always embedded.

And then I had a friend in Melbourne who used to back in the eighties and the seventies. He he ran a program called Newsbeat, which was his job every single night was to go out in the news car and attend accidents. That was his job.

And I said to him, I was drinking with him. I said, how do you do it? He said, I don't know. I said, I've seen in the last 10 years you wouldn't believe the stuff I've seen because he is there.

And in all our news cars back then, we had two way radios and police scanners. So, you know, we could be at we could tell and the police on their scanner, which we were allowed to have as news journalists back then. We often get there at the same time that the police and the emergency services got there to a scene.

And yeah, the kind of horrific things that you would see is just out of this world. And that's why I wanted to get away from that a bit because I'm a bit too sensitive for all that stuff. I could never do that in 10 years.

It just drives me absolutely mental to go through that every week. And I don't know how those guys did it. Very tough guys and girls who did that sort of thing.

Yeah. Yeah. And it was almost expected that you needed to be tough to be able to survive being in the media.

You know, it's almost like it was expected to have this kind of toughness about you. Otherwise, you just would not survive. And this is why sometimes journalists can be blunt.

And I say to people with my media training, you know, sometimes when journalists are being, you know, it might seem like they're being rude or being blunt to you. But it's just because they're under incredible stress that, you know, they have full on deadlines. And it's becoming even worse now, I would say, as time's gone on.

And there's less and less staff now, less and less team members to do the work. So there's even more pressure now. Even more now.

It's 24-hour a day news cycle now. You can't get away from it because it's not only the radio and TV. It's the social media.

It's the Facebook pages. It's the company pages. People are devouring news in a big way.

And I think the stress on the current journalists is even more than it was. And people think it's easier. It isn't because, yeah, you might have to post something every hour of every day, your original stuff, you know.

And what you say about being tough is really, really true, too, because I spent about five years as a court reporter for the Melbourne Magistrates Court, you know, and being there every single day, seeing all these people and criminals and getting to know them and getting to know their stories. And they would open up to you, funnily enough, because you wouldn't think that a journalist would be the person that a criminal would open up to. But they sort of thought, well, and one guy I got to know quite well was Chopper Reed, you know, because he was around then in the 80s and I got friendly with him.

And, you know, and he had a sort of respect for journalists to say, yeah, you're sort of like us, you know, you're on the front line here, mate, you know, you're tough, you know, you come to the court and we see you and give you a wave and everything, you know. And these people are like murderers and killers and super hard criminals. But they also had a bit of respect for us as journalists, where they sort of treated us as a sort of equal type thing, not as equal in their criminal world, but they knew that we could show them in a particular light.

And if you watch the movie Chopper, you know, which is all about his life, he absolutely loved the media because the media was his way of getting to be famous, you know. So in many ways, these people were like all over us as friends and it was a bit weird. You know, they'd say, listen, mate, I've just got out.

Yeah. You know, I know he's sending me to 10 years for murder, but would you like to come down to the pub later and have a drink? I say, well, I say, well, yeah, all right. You know, it sounds like fun, you know.

Yeah, but the guy I murdered, he deserved it, mate. You know, he asked for it, you know, but I like you, though. You're a cool guy.

I like you. Oh, my goodness me, you know, it was quite amusing, you know, and I wouldn't change it for the world because it was really, really amazing. Yeah, I interviewed Chopper Reed actually in the early 2000s as well as the entertainment reporter at The Sun.

And I remember when he did a show, he did a show at the art center back then. I remember the show. He was a standup comedian in the end, you know.

And you know what it's like, his charisma is incredible. He's a very night of all guy for a mass murderer, you know, crazy. Yeah, yeah, absolutely.

We've got some people watching. We'll say hello to our we've got Ninji. Hello, name.

Nice to see you there. Hi, name. Ahmed Fayad here.

Hello, Ahmed. Good to see you. We've got Mike Coleman saying best of luck.

Your gorgeous mum, Betty Harrison, just hopped on. Thank you, Betty. Thank you so much for the introduction.

20 years ago with your son. On the Gold Coast, yeah. Yeah, from the Gold Coast, Jeff and I were just saying how amazing it is that we've stayed in touch all these years and we've been through so much.

So, Betty, you're a very good connector. There you go. You must have known that Jeff and I needed to catch up.

So, so I really think without my mum, without my mum has been so supportive of me all through my career. She's been and my dad, of course, who passed away recently, Tom, and you were at his funeral, you know, his memorial. And yeah, it was amazing, amazing people.

We've as a family, we've all been around the world and all done some incredible, had some incredible experiences. So it's fantastic. And so thanks, mom.

Thanks, dad. I know dad's looking down on this as well. So, yeah, thanks.

Yes, he is. Cool. I'm getting goosebumps.

It was a phenomenal funeral. And what a gosh, what an amazing parents you had together. 60

odd years.

Just exciting. Oh, getting emotional. You know, you have come from very good stock, Jeff.

You know, you have great family. Yeah, fantastic family and a family that went around the world. You know, by the time I was 15, I lived in the London, Ireland, Los Angeles and Australia.

By the time I was 15, so it was an incredible, incredible journey and ride for all of us, you know, and that went back to my dad. As I said, he was working in electrical engineering all around the world. So we got to travel at an incredible time.

And it's been an incredible life. You know, it's just been amazing. And the next 10 years are going to be incredible as well with the whole convergence of streaming media and the way that everyone can participate and everyone can be on television now without having to be, you know, super professional journalists.

People can become their own journalists these days. They can. And I know you do.

You say that in your courses that you give them advice on how they do that. And you're, you know, how to get free publicity and how to because that's what it's all about now is getting your message out there to the world. And the Internet has been such a game changer, as you know, back in nineteen eighty ninety ninety four.

Actually, I was at the Winter Olympics in Norway and we had something there called in Lillehammer. We had something they called an intranet, which was just a connected group of computers in a private land system, you know, a system, local area network. And when I first got to the Olympics, they said, welcome to Norway.

Welcome to Lillehammer. You're a journalist for the Olympics. Here is your email address.

And I said, what are you talking about? What is that? They said, it's an email where you can actually go on our local computer system in the in the media village and you can arrange things like meeting up with people and sending people messages. And I said, wow, that is absolutely incredible. It was so well organized.

And that was in ninety four. And that was all on the military system because the actual, you know, the system where everyone had an email didn't come till maybe ninety six, ninety seven. You know, that's when it really started to hit properly.

And back then ninety four, we were two years before the consumer Internet. And and I remember going in. I actually met a very nice woman in Stockholm after the Olympics and said to her, we must keep in touch.

She said, yeah, well, I work for GE General Electric, so I have an email address as well. So I

actually took her email address and flew to New York from Norway and Sweden, actually. That's where I fell in love with Stockholm and Sweden in general.

And I went to New York and I had a few emails piling up that I remember walking into a big city Wall Street office thinking they will have a computer here with email. They must, you know, they were they're a huge Wall Street investment firm. And I walked into the lady at the front desk.

I said, hello, I'm sorry to bother you. I'm a journalist from Australia. And I was wondering if you have email and access to email here because I can't check my emails.

And she said, sir, I have absolutely no idea what the hell you're talking about. And if you don't leave, I'm going to call security. I said, you don't use email.

She says, I've never heard of email. I don't know who you are. We don't get out.

So I said, OK. So I spent the next month or so trying to find somewhere that even had even heard of email that was in ninety four. Ninety four.

So how the world changes, you know, how it is quite quite incredible. Amazing. Yeah.

Well, I was at the newspaper back then back at Curio. And we had we had using Quark Express to edit the paper back then to Australia, the illustrator. And we actually had emails, too, at the in the newsroom there in the student union at Canberra University.

Yeah. And we had an intranet in the newspaper newsrooms as well. We had intranets.

So unless you're in India or in government, you probably didn't know about it, I guess. No, no, no. No one.

Everyone discovered it around about 1996. Normal, everyday people thought, hang on, I can message. I've got email and they did a whole movie about it.

You've got mail. There was a whole movie about that. You know, with Tom Hanks.

And yeah, it's incredible because it was so new and so different. And I feel sorry for the kids these days because they didn't experience the actual old world where you didn't have an email. You had to either ring someone up or send them a letter, a handwritten letter.

And, you know, when you rang someone in about 20 bucks or three minutes, if you were going on distance and you couldn't attach anything, you couldn't, you know, all that kind of thing was its infancy. So, yeah, how the world has just changed within the period of 20 years. It's just completely changed the whole planet, which is very exciting.

Yes, it is. Now, Betty, your beautiful mum, she's saying 64 years she was with Tom. Wow.

Oh, yes. 64 years married. Yeah, they got married in 1956.

Sixty four. She said, what about radio events, Melbourne? Oh, yes. Yeah.

Yeah. We ran in the that the federal government in Australia allows you to start an event radio station for an event like the Commonwealth Games or the Grand Prix. You can go on air for about a week or two with a temporary radio station.

And we did that in Melbourne for the Grand Prix, the first ever Melbourne Grand Prix. We ran Grand Prix radio from home in Richmond where my mum was helping me with that as well. And we had a whole radio station set up in a living room broadcasting to the whole of Melbourne on 91.5 FM.

And that was Grand Prix radio. And that was our first big one that we went into. Then we went on to do Masters Games radio and World Police Fire Games radio under those same circumstances where you can get a temporary license.

And that is very exciting to do. And I want to do a few more of those in the coming years for various events as well. They do those for things like the Australian Open in Melbourne, you know, the big sporting events have their own temporary radio stations.

So that's very exciting to do as well. So, yeah, I know I do believe the Big Bowls Championship, you have the World Bowls Championship on the Gold Coast. And they also have their own radio and television channels running temporarily, which is pretty exciting stuff.

And that's a very exciting area to begin as well. Well, it's fantastic that you've got your finger on the pulse. So let's talk more about streaming media, which is our topic today.

We can talk for hours about your story and the media. I'd say we'll do more interviews and more chats down the track with you, Geoff, because you've got such an amazing history. And I'm sure you've interviewed some phenomenal people as well in your time.

Actually, just who are some of the big names you've interviewed just before we get on to streaming media? Recently, the Hoff, David Hasselhoff last year at the London Ski Show. And he was very, very gracious. And we can do a link to that.

It's on YouTube. Jeff Harrison interviews the Hoff. You can see that on streaming media on YouTube, actually.

Back in the early 80s, I interviewed Neil Sadaka, who's a very famous singer. And had lunch with him and dinner with his family and all that kind of thing. And numerous, numerous people in Melbourne society.

But Newton was one of my bosses. But Newton was my boss on 3D radio in Melbourne. And, you

know, oh, there's a whole range of people that I could mention that it'd probably be another half an hour just on that stuff.

And Peter Ford, actually, you know, Peter Ford, the entertainment reporter in Australia. I actually helped him crash the Logies one year because he didn't have an invite. That was when he was about 23 years old.

And he didn't have an invite to the Logies. And I did. So I snuck him into the Logies.

And they didn't want him there. They said, who are you? You don't have an invite. I said, oh, he's with me.

He's my producer. He's my producer. He's coming in with me.

And we went up to Ray Martin, Ray Martin, who ran the midday show in Australia for many years. And I walked up to Ray Martin in the after party at the Logies. It was at Crown, actually, Crown Casino.

And I said to Ray, Ray Jeff Harrison, you know, accredited journalist. And this is my producer, Peter Ford. And he said, I've never heard of any.

I've never heard either of you. I said, well, yes, that's true. That's true, Ray.

But Peter here is destined to become one of the greatest entertainment reporters in Australia. And he said, I very much doubt that. I very much doubt that.

And he was wrong. And Peter will tell you that story if you ever catch up with him, because the day we crashed the Logies, we actually crashed it with Jane Holmes as well. She snuck it with me as well.

Jane Holmes, who was a very, very famous Melbourne radio personality and morning host. So we've got all those little fun stories as well. But he ended up interviewing him.

So it was quite funny how all those things happened. And I think the biggest person I interviewed was Michael Jackson in Melbourne, when he was in Melbourne. Yeah, at the Hyatt Hotel.

And it was his after party. And I did a little quick interview with him, which is I can't, I don't even know where the interview is now, because I interviewed him on tape. And he was very nice.

And he said, hang out with my band. And I ended up taking the band to the Ivy nightclub, which is right next door to the Hyatt in Melbourne. And that was owned by Glenn Wheatley.

And the drummer from that band, he ended up playing with the house band. He ended up, it was Michael Jackson's drummer, who was also the drummer for Madonna and Prince. So he ended up doing an impromptu set with the house band at the Ivy that night.

So that was pretty exciting as well. Amazing, amazing. And I've also had the great pleasure to interview some phenomenal people like Cindy Lauper, Hugh Jackman, Russell Crowe.

In America, I interviewed Vanilla Ice, Charlie Sheen, Jewel, some phenomenal people. And these little people just like you and I, these celebrities, they're just like you and I, they're just people that have followed their passions, right? They love what they do. And they've gone out and they've created something extraordinary with their imagination, with their talents, with their whatever it is.

They're passionate people that have gone out no matter what. They've gone and done what they love to do, which I think is the trick to life. And using technology to actually get it out now is so exciting, which brings me back to streaming media.

So back to streaming media, the potential of streaming media. So can you tell us a bit, Jeff, for those that don't really understand this world, what are we really looking at when we're looking at the future of global broadcasting? Well, we're talking about over-the-top broadcasting, which is OTT. Now, a lot of people get that confused and they say, what is this OTT thing? Because this is what you're going to hear, over-the-top broadcasting.

Over-the-top broadcasting means an IP-delivered platform. And one of the OTT platforms that has become very famous is something called Netflix. Now, Netflix is an over-the-top... Basically, it's a website with a bunch of movies on it.

That's all Netflix is, right? But now it's been integrated into platforms, distribution platforms around the world where you can access it very easily on your TV if your TV is connected. So I think about, you know, probably seven out of 10 TV watches in the world have access to Netflix at the moment, and Netflix is absolutely huge around the world. That's a prime example of OTT media.

And in the future, all of these TV channels like mine, like Ski TV and other specialised channels can get onto these platforms as well and become OTT streaming outlets themselves. So you have two things. You have the channels and you have the platforms.

So platforms are things like... Foxtel is a satellite-delivered platform, but there's a lot of other platforms coming up. I think in Australia you have things like Stan TV, which is a purely an example of OTT IP-delivered platform. So that's a good example.

So then you have channels on that platform you can watch, which are streamed without having to go through satellite or without having to go through normal on-air transmission. It's delivered by the internet. So that's the way of the future.

And the whole future of OTT media is really coming to the fore in the next five years. OTT platforms and streaming media will be the dominant platform. At the moment it's getting up to the normal media such as satellite-delivered and broadcast-delivered.

But OTT is nearly equalling it now and within two to five years it will take over completely with those kinds of things. So a lot of the traditional media that we've all been watching, the old-fashioned channels, are now also beginning to stream themselves because they also understand that this is the future and they don't want to be left behind and left behind out of the streaming platforms. This gives a lot of the OTT platforms give a lot of opportunity for channels like mine, specialized channels to become like Golf TV.

Golf TV started out as an internet system back in the early 2000s, late 90s. Now it's a totally full-on broadcast. It's NBC Golf now.

And it used to be just a little channel like mine, like Ski TV. So the possibilities for the future are incredible. You've got to identify your market.

You've got to have a market that's willing to watch your channel and then you can create something around that. And the good thing about Ski TV is we have, as I said before, about 100 to 200 million active skiers in the world who like skiing and who are interested in watching a channel like that. But there are also a lot of channels that could be around such as a knitting channel or a, you know, because the amount of knitters in the world, for instance, probably dwarfs anything, ski, golf, everything put together.

You know, there's a huge market for that. Probably a billion people in the world out of 6 billion are into knitting. It's incredible.

And there's no channels to look after them. And that's what's going to happen in the future as well. You know, how a niche subject can become a broadcast or OTT channel.

Yeah. And there's a lot of, and you've seen yourself, the explosion in food channels, in DIY channels and all this sort of thing. It's all starting to explode now.

So it doesn't matter what, it's not a channel giving you what it thinks you want. It's you choosing a channel that suits you. And it's up to us broadcasters and OTT providers to create these channels that fit to the market.

And that's the way it is. So everything will be specialized. Not because back in the, you know, 70s, 80s, 90s, all the channels were trying to be all things to all people.

But now it's being segmented and sliced up. So if you like skiing, you watch the TV. If you like golf, you watch golf TV.

If you like knitting, you watch knitting TV. That's the way it's going. And there's probably thousands of channels coming up in the next five years to cater for your every whim, which is very exciting.

That is very exciting. And so for content providers, it needs to be a certain quality, right? Exactly,

yes. To actually make it onto these channels.

Blackfolds. Blackfolds, yeah. So what kind of quality are we looking at? What do, you know, people want to create their own show? What do they need? Well, it's funny because the quality that you broadcast or on any platform equals the amount of people who are going to be interested enough to keep watching your platform.

So it's no use putting up a bunch of content that is just someone in their bedroom, just, you know, like YouTube. It's completely different to that. You have to have decent quality, which looks good on TV and looks at maybe nearly broadcast quality or equal to broadcast quality before you get people watching on a regular basis because people are so fussy these days.

You know, they want to watch. And even people producing YouTube content, their quality of content is absolutely unbelievable. It's broadcast quality that you'd see 10 years ago on any major television channel.

So the bar has been set very high. So if you want to produce something for broadcast, it better be good, better be pretty good quality. You know, on ski TV, we search for content that is very exciting, well-produced, well-edited, good sound, good lighting, all that sort of thing to present to our viewers.

That day, there's also a lot of bloggers who are making great content that they're just doing from their home or on their ski trips. It's perfectly acceptable as well because it gives ski TV a range because ski TV is not like a channel such as Red Bull TV, which is, we use some of their content too. We had an agreement with Red Bull TV.

But Red Bull TV is more into the extreme side of the market. You know, it's all extreme ski, extreme content, whereas our content is more of a magazine-style show where you can find out about food and wine and resort guides and all that sort of stuff. Rather than just watching people throw themselves off mountains or out of helicopters, which is really great, but we're not that focused because that's Red Bull TV's area.

And, you know, Red Bull TV probably spend about \$200 million a year just on production, you know? So we can't really compete with them in that area. But you won't see a ski resort guide on Red Bull TV because that's not what they're after. They're after a completely different wheel.

So it's horses for courses, really, you know? It depends what your market is, what the interest level, and you must have some decent quality content. Yes, content is king. That's the words, you know? And king content drives everything these days.

If you haven't got good quality content, you don't have a channel, you don't have... And it's all about capturing the eyeballs and making the eyeballs come back. And that's the way the advertisers look at it, too. And you've got to have a hell of a lot of eyeballs to start making some

money, as you know, in this business.

Especially on YouTube, you can have like 100,000 viewers and you're nowhere, you know? You're just on your cliff. It's crazy, you know? The amount of competition out there is incredible. Yes, it is.

So it's having the right message to the right audience at the right time, even. Yes, exactly. And having a good variety of content, good quality.

There's nothing worse than shaky camera, for example. Oh, yes. Using tripods are crucial.

Or having steady cameras are really important, lighting, framing, all those kind of things. And a lot of people are learning about that now, even on Zoom, they're learning about composition, lighting, framing. And they would say to people like us, oh, I tried to do something like it.

You said, yeah, but you tried to do something, but you had a light source behind your head, shining at the camera, which is you never do that. We know never to do that because it completely ruins, it will throw your whole face into shadow. So you've got to have really good lighting on your face.

I mean, I'm here in my room here in Amsterdam and I have two big windows in front of me shining light onto my face. Now, that could be a light source as well, but I don't need it because it would be too much light. But if I had the windows behind me, my whole face would be in shadow.

And that's what a lot of people don't understand when they're doing photography or trying to record a film clip or trying to record something on Zoom. Your lighting is so crucial, so crucial, because it can make the difference between you looking like a horrific alien or looking nice. So the lighting is very important.

And positioning and where you are and framing all sorts of things. But people are learning about that now, which is really great. It's really good.

And the kids especially, the teenagers are so into this stuff. The stuff they're making, their vlogs from home there. And that's why a lot of them have become YouTube stars in themselves because they produce this stuff too, they're max.

I mean, they've got hundreds of thousands, if not millions of viewers, and they're just doing it from their bedroom. But they've got everything set up completely correctly. You know, it's so beautiful to look at and so professional to look at, but they just might be talking about a product or what they did that day.

You don't realize the work that's gone in to setting up that studio. It's quite a bit of work. It's not just pointing your camera phone at yourself.

It's a whole lot more than that. Yes, it's quite a bit. I've got a studio set up here.

I've got a green screen. I've got a special mic. I've got a softbox light on my face.

So, you know, it says quite a lot going on here. And, you know, it's important to understand this and to get your head around the technology because if you want to present the best way you can online, then it's important to have the right tech and at least to start educating yourself on this. So we are in a time... Oh, and the great thing... Yeah, just one more thing.

The great thing about that is if you want to do this at home, you can buy all this stuff on eBay for so cheap these days, can't you? I mean, you can get softbox lights for a hundred bucks or, you know, whatever. It's very easy to organize it if you really want to do a problem. And I'd encourage people to do that.

It's cheaper now than ever before. I mean, I've got a three-meter green screen that cost me about \$400 back in the day. It's a proper thick velvet green screen.

But now you can get them on eBay for a hundred bucks. You know, as you say, you can get them all set up with the stands and everything, you know? Everything, like 500 bucks. Use your own camera.

Use your own phone as a camera. You know, people do that all the time. It's incredible.

Yes. So massive opportunity for those who do want to produce their own content. And, you know, people follow people.

There's a great book that Sam Cawthorn from Speakers Institute just did called People Follow People. You know, we want to connect with people. And actually, content consumption since COVID has gone up at least 60% that we know of.

So more and more people are going online, looking for information, looking to connect with people, looking to learn about specialist niche subjects, such as skiing and knitting and all these different things, right? So, you know, what is it that you can bring to the world if you're watching this right now? You know, what genius do you have? You know, what are you possibly thinking? What genre do you want to go into? Start producing a few things. And yeah, there's a million different subjects out there. A million.

The people can come around. Yeah, look at what interests you right now. What are you spending your time? What sort of hobbies are you doing right now that you can start something around? So massive opportunity.

And with the world now of streaming media and the future of global broadcasting, such massive opportunity to get your message to the masses now with this amazing technology. And so in saying that, Jeff, what is the future of ski TV going to look like? Well, we're just about to launch on

some really big major platforms in the United States. We're just about to go onto Vizio.

Vizio, V-I-Z-I-O. And they have their own TVs in 33 million homes in America. We're just about to go onto the local Now Network, which has 7.5 million monthly unique viewers.

We're going on Putin TV in Europe onto 90 million users. We're already on Roku, which actually, Roku actually owns Netflix, not the other way around. Roku is huge in the United States.

And we're looking at Stan TV in Australia. And yeah, we're just going to increase our distribution, you know, hugely over the next six months and ready for the opening of the ski season in 2021-22. I know that the ski season has just opened in Australia and New Zealand.

And we're very involved with these Australian ski resorts as well. In New Zealand, they send us all their content. And yeah, we want to ramp up to become one to an equivalent of Golf TV, which is now a massive, massive broadcast channel in the United States.

So that's the future for ski TV. It's about a two-year program. And we've just got some major investment from the United States and from New York.

And we are moving ahead to become a really big force in the streaming television world now. And people can check us out, skitv.tv. You can see all of our, you can see our live stream there. You can see all sorts of things there on our website.

Here is skitv.tv. I'll just pop that into the comments for anyone who wants to check that out. skitv.tv. And if you go to Watch Live, you can see what is broadcasting on ski TV 24 hours a day on the Watch Live tab, which starts automatically. And we also have a link here to a great video you've done on ski TV as well.

It's on YouTube, so you can check that out as well. Yeah. Wow, very exciting.

And this is the thing, for those who want to get some content out and to possibly like ski TV, get themselves out in some of these major platforms, you know, all these channels are looking for content, right? They're looking for content like ever before. So it's a very exciting time now to actually, you know, become your own radio star or TV star and get out there and do it and share yourself. And, you know, it's very, very exciting, Jeff.

And so excited for the future of skiTV.tv. Your mum's saying here that you are, as she says, Jeff is in the Hall of Fame. She says Jeff is the radio Hall of Fame. Yeah, absolutely.

Yeah, I'm on the 3AK Radio Hall of Fame in Melbourne. Yeah, together with a bunch of other radio stars and that sort of thing. But I never saw myself as a celeb.

I was just an overnight radio guy and a guy set up this page, the 3AK Hall of Fame. And 3AK is a big station and I was involved with them part time for many, many years as an announcer. And

yeah, he stuck me in there, which is very, very flattering.

And because there's some big names on the 3AK Hall of Fame. And 3AK actually was located at Channel 9 in Bendigo Street. That's where the studios were.

So I did a lot of work with Peter Hitchcock and all those guys and Newton and, you know, and quite funny because on 3AK I was the overnight announcer when it was in the beautiful music format. And we were number one in Melbourne. Believe it or not, with the beautiful music format, it was incredible.

And so Eric Pearce, I don't know whether you've heard of him, but he's a very, very famous. He's a bit like Brian Henderson in Sydney. He was the equivalent of Brian Henderson.

And so Eric Pearce was the chief newsreader before Brian Maller at Channel 9 in Melbourne. And his cat Marmalade used to come and sleep with me overnight in the studio. And the cat actually, and 3AK is the fourth-door building at Bendigo Street in Melbourne.

And the cat used to ride the lift. So he'd sit there and look at people saying, press the button for me. And he'd go from floor to floor, getting his treats during the day.

And then, you know, he just had it down. You know, anyone who comes to the lift, he'd just say, hello, press the button. You know, come on, get your act together.

I need to go to the third floor now. And at night he used to come in and sleep in the studio with me. And I, you know, stroking, which is great when I was working because it was so great because he'd always hit the place at the exact time.

He'd always hit at 1am. He'd be waiting outside the studio door to come in and jump up on the desk and sleep overnight, ready for his big next day of being spoiled by everybody at Channel 9. So it was quite amazing. And, yeah, if you look him up, Marmalade, the lift-riding cat, you'll find him.

He's just, you know, and he was one of those typical ginger, you know, cats. And he belonged to Sir Eric Pierce, which was quite amazing. And Sir Eric used to come to me and say, Jeff, I'm, and he had a very posh English accent.

Jeff, I'm very, very, very happy that you are looking after Marmalade every night. Thank you very much, Jeffrey. It's a very good review.

And, yes, Marmalade is very happy, you know, all that kind of thing. So that was back in the days of the Don Lane show. Don Lane has been produced every night.

And actually, after the Don Lane after party, people used to walk by my studio, and I used to, they used to come in. I mean, international superstars, because they'd say, oh, there's a radio. They'd

all had a few drinks at the after party.

And they'd say, oh, can we come in and say hello? And one very early morning at about 1.30, a very, very enebriated Gloria Gaynor coming in. And she was completely smashed on the wide. I said, she goes, hello, I'm Gloria Gaynor.

I said, I know you are, Gloria. She says, can I say hello to your listeners? I said, sure you can. Honk yourself down.

She was completely smashed. And I said, and she was slurring everything. She's completely slurred.

I just want to say thank you for listening to my song. I will survive. And I made it as an anthem for everybody.

And I said, well, that's wonderful, Gloria. Thank you for popping by. It was hilarious.

It was so funny. That sort of used to happen a lot, yeah. Oh, wow.

I think there's a whole book in you, Jeff. I think so. I think so.

I'm looking forward to reading that when and if you put that out. I think it'll be amazing. Yeah.

And I love that song, I Will Survive. I love it. Well, actually, they said, and we were playing it back in 1978 when it first came out.

We all thought, oh, this is going to be a bit of a one-hit wonder. You know, this isn't going to last very long, but they're still playing it today. It's like a song that any DJ will put on that song, and it's instantly fulfilled.

That's like four years later, 45 years later. Yes. My goodness.

It's incredible how that works. It's still big. You're such an adventurer, Jeff.

I can just imagine some of the stories that you have along your adventures. Do you think you'll constantly be traveling for the rest of your life? Or do you think one day you might just stop somewhere one day? You've been in Holland for how many years now? Oh, 17 years in the Netherlands. I just became a Dutch resident, actually.

Yeah, because I'm a British citizen. I'm an Australian resident, but I'm also a Swedish resident as well because I spent quite a few years in Sweden. If I was going to stay somewhere, I'd probably be in Sweden because the houses are really cheap there outside the cities, and it's beautiful.

I love Swedish people. I love the whole Swedish culture and it's such a beautiful place. But probably even if I did have a house there, I'd probably be traveling six months a year anyway.

It's just a base in Europe, but I do love Amsterdam. Amsterdam is equal on my list of Sweden. For anyone who's been to Amsterdam, you know what a stunningly beautiful historic city it is, and the people I love being.

It's just a great place to be. Amsterdam and the Netherlands is my top pick in Europe, apart from the ski resorts in Europe, which there are maybe 3,000 ski resorts in Europe, so there's a lot to choose from as well. Wow.

Here's a bit of a deeper question for you. What advice would you give your younger self, knowing what you know now, having experienced what you've experienced, what advice would you give a younger version of you? Stay off the booze, number one. Number two, try and keep away from the ladies if you can possibly do that, because the ladies can get you into a lot of trouble.

All right. Yeah, and can cause a lot of heartbreak and a lot of, yeah. So try not to get, and don't take yourself too seriously.

Don't get into the whole ego thing. I never really did that. I was never one to say I'm a famous person, because I've seen a lot of famous people and I've seen the detrimental side of them.

Perhaps in my early 20s I wanted to be a bit famous, but that soon got knocked out of me when I saw the negative part of being famous by hanging around quite a few famous people in Australia. And I saw the restrictions that are put on their lives in many ways, that they can't just go out and have a meal and be private. Privacy, believe me, kids, if you want to be famous, it's not all that's cracked up to be, because you lose your privacy, you lose all the things that you work at which you think are going to be beneficial when you're famous, have completely the opposite effect, because people, you lose, and privacy is number one.

And once you can't go outside the door, it doesn't matter how much money you have or how successful you are or how famous you are. And being famous means you cannot go and just have a meal without all eyes on you, and that is very, very awkward. It's very, very wary now for a while.

And that's why a lot of these super famous people turn to artificial substances because they just can't handle it, because they've got all the money, they've got the cars, but they're locked away in cages, and that's not a good thing for anybody's mental health. It's not a good thing. So if you try and be... If you're going to get into the media, there's a very famous guy called Casey Casem, who ran American Top 40, and his line was, and it's a very famous line and very true, reach for the stars, but keep your feet on the ground.

That was his famous saying, and that's what I'd advise any kids these days. Don't let all the lights and the, you know, the hunt for fame change you as a person. Always remain the same as you are, and just enjoy small things.

Just going out for a meal and just being free to go and relax with your friends and hang out and do things like that. It's very, very, very important, and that's the real highlights of your life, not being the center of attention, not being at the big scene and not being part of this thing. You are allowed to be in the background, and that's probably sometimes the best way to be.

Yeah. I think that's brilliant advice. So, Jeff, when you're not doing ski TV, what sort of things do you enjoy doing in Europe? Well, I'm a magician here.

I'm a professional magician. That's the only other job when I'm not doing ski TV, and I work around with about 20 restaurants, bars in Amsterdam, and they allow me to come in and do magic for their patrons, and I enjoy that. I get a bit of release from that, from all the media stuff, and yeah, I've been a professional magician since 96 on and off around the world, and yeah, that's been very, very enjoyable as well.

So, it allows me to be a bit of a performer without being behind the scenes, because ski TV, I'm very much behind the scenes. I don't like being on camera. I'm very much a producer.

You know, I'm a director producer behind the camera, not in front of it these days, and yeah, that's what I do to sort of have my performing side come out and get the reaction from people, which is very good too, so yeah, it's good. You're very good at that, I must say. Your magic is extraordinary, and it's very difficult, I would say, to do a slight of hand magic like you do.

However, you know, every time I've seen you do your magic, people just absolutely love it, and you blow them away. So, you know, that's just another side of you. And then apart from that, what about things, you know, what about like hobbies for you? What about like, you know, dining out? I don't know, what sort of things do you do in the Netherlands? Well, I just ride my bike.

I love to ride. I love to ride my bike, because everyone rides bikes here in the Netherlands, especially in Amsterdam. So we're just wonderful to just get on the bike and go for a big long bike ride at the same 20 kilometers, and it's all flat gear, so there's no hills.

There might be a little bridge occasionally, but that's it. So I have friends who live in a place called Nerdon, which is a beautiful Spanish fort town, about 18 kilometers out of Amsterdam, and it's a lady who I used to work with back in, and she's got a little girl who I do magic for her and her friends when I go down there, and she's there with her partner, and I just love taking a ride out there and doing, you know, hanging out with families and doing my, you know, just a basic thing like that is a big day out for me. And the other thing I love to do here in Amsterdam, you can get a boat for like 21 euro and jump on the boat, and it's a whole-hour boat ride through the canals, and it's an open bar, so if you want to have a drink, you can.

You can have a beer or wine, all included. And I'd like to take my friends on that. If I have a friend to show them around Amsterdam, I'd just say, let's just jump on the boat for an hour.

It's equivalent of about 30 bucks, you know, and I have one or two drinks, but some of them hit it, you know, you can have as many drinks in the air as you like, and that's Boat Amsterdam dot com. And they have beautiful, big boats, and they take you all around, and I say to my friends, if you are an alcoholic, just go around again, you know. It's fine, you know.

It's cheaper than drinking in the bars, my friend, you know. I mean, you just have a boat amid all these crazy people, you know. It's pretty good, yeah.

Yeah, so that sort of thing is great. Yeah, Amsterdam has really set up well to do that sort of thing, and just the people in Amsterdam are so beautiful, and the people I've known here for 17 years are just, I'm part of their family, because it's like a little village Amsterdam. It's a bit like surface paradise, you know.

You can see, once you get in there, you know pretty much everyone after a while, you know. It's a great feeling of the village atmosphere here. It's really good.

Yeah, beautiful, beautiful. And on the point of drinking, everything in moderation, okay. Everything in moderation.

Have a drink or two once in a while, but just keep it down. Don't go crazy. You don't have to keep drinking until you're falling over.

You don't have to do that, you know. That's one thing I've learned now, that I tell my young self, don't keep going. Just have a few and then hit the mineral water.

You're still drinking, hit the mineral water. Yes, exactly. Mix it up with water in between, absolutely.

So that's a massive headache afterwards. Or doing something you might regret. Yes, yes, well that's right too, that's right.

And what happens in those ski resorts, stays in the ski resorts, right Jeff? Exactly, we won't go there. We won't go there. No, okay.

I don't know how I survived it actually. Yeah. Well, you're looking amazing for 35, Jeff, I must say.

Actually 39, thank you very much. I'm offended by 39. I'm going to be 39 for the rest of my life.

Yeah. Jeff, amazing what you've done. Congratulations on all of your achievements and on ski TV onwards and upwards.

It's so exciting. And, you know, you've stuck by ski TV. It's been quite a few years now and it's just going from strength to strength.

So it just goes to show, you know, when you stick with something, when you're really passionate

about something, you know, hang in there and, you know, it's amazing what can happen. Not a short process. Nothing, nothing, nothing worthwhile is overnight.

And I have a friend of mine and he said to me the other day, people are saying that I'm an overnight success but it's only taken me 40 years to get here, to have this overnight success. They oversee the successful part, none of the crap behind it. Yeah, yeah, exactly.

Some people say it takes a lifetime to be an overnight success, right? Exactly. That's right. The main thing is just stay on your path.

Be true to yourself. Do what you love. I think that's the big trick to life is just, you know, do what you love.

Because, you know, a third of people die by the age of 65. And Jeff, I think you're a great example of someone who has definitely made the most of life and continue to make the most of life. And, you know, you're just extraordinary.

I always enjoy chatting with you. I miss hanging out with you since you haven't been on the Gold Coast for so long. And, you know, you even had a studio here on the Gold Coast there for a while.

In Southport, we did some great stuff there together. So, you know, you've done some extraordinary things. And I really want to thank you for your time, Jeff.

It's been amazing. Now, any final words you'd like to leave people with before we wrap up today? Be yourself and stay true to your dream. Have a dream.

Stay true to it. And don't let the obstacles get in the way. If you really believe in it, go for it.

And do what you love, you know? Don't do what you hate just for the money or whatever. Don't do that. Find something you love.

And even if you have to do it part-time for a while, get into something you really, really love, and then everything else will fall in place, everything else. And one more thing, just be your own best friend. Be your own best friend.

You don't need other people to make you whole. You don't be a compliment to another person. But if it doesn't work out, you've still got yourself as your best friend.

And that's very, very important, I think, in relationship area. Yes, yeah, great advice there. You know, you're with yourself from the beginning when we come into the world.

We're with ourselves at the end as well. So, you know, learning to be your own best friend, I think that is massive. You know, having that self-love and, you know, being able to fill your own cup up so you can help others with the overflow, right? So, you know, being the best version, the best

version of yourself, which you certainly are, Geoff, and always enjoy chatting with people.

I'm trying. You're doing a great job. Thank you.

So check out Ski TV for those watching this. Thank you so much for joining us. And Geoff is actually going to be presenting at one of our mass media tribe events.

We've just locked the date in for October 6th, 7 till 9 p.m. Australian Eastern Standard Time, which in the Netherlands will be noon on the 6th, from noon till 2 p.m. on the 6th of October. So Geoff is actually going to present a slideshow presentation and go into a lot more detail on this same topic, streaming media, the future of global broadcasting, which will be amazing. So I hope you can join us for that.

We haven't got the promo out yet, but you've got the date. So lock it in, 6th of October. And we have mass media.

That'll be amazing. And we have mass media tribe events every month leading up to that. We also have the Global Good News Challenge currently on right now, which you can start your Global Good News Challenge, sharing gratitude and good news.

You can start that any time before tomorrow. It's a six-day Facebook Live challenge. All the details are in the Global Good News Challenge Facebook page, pinned to the top of the page.

It's a very powerful thing to do to get into gratitude, particularly at a time now where some people are really struggling during COVID, et cetera. So, you know, you can shift your state just by thinking of something you're grateful for even better. Speak it out.

Speak out what you are grateful for. Not only will you shift your own energy, you'll be able to shift the energy of those around you. And that is incredibly powerful.

So the link for that and all my links, social media links, are in linktree.org, which you'll see in the chat there. And the one link there goes to all my social media channels. I also have some events next week.

I'm running the how you can gain a million dollars worth of free publicity, free webinar. I'm doing one at 11 a.m. on Monday and one at 7 p.m. next Thursday. And in fact, Geoff, I've got a slide in there about Surfers Paradise Beach Radio.

When we're in the Gold Coast Bulletin together, I'm standing for Beach Radio to come back. So you actually get mentioned in those webinars. So if you want to hop along, you'll be able to see a photo of Geoff and myself on the beach with Pete the Surferoo and Dane, one of our other friends then on the beach, and ended up being in the Gold Coast Bulletin as a poll.

And there was a poll going for, you know, do we want Surfers Beach Radio back again? That was

just one of the amazing things we've done together, Geoff, as well as attended many expos. And we got 70 percent, 70 percent of Gold Coast people in the bulletin said they wanted Beach Radio back. But the council said no.

So boo-boo-boo to the council. Yes, boo-hoo to the council. You know, the council of you are just shocking on the Gold Coast, I must say.

But let's not go there. Thank God there's good people here on the Gold Coast. But the council, well, let's not go there.

They can make things very hard sometimes. And, you know, yes, it's just a whole other world. But anyway, that's governments for you in general.

So we won't go there. However, Geoff, look, absolute pleasure to be with you and really thankful for your time today and for your sharing your wisdom and some of your amazing journeys. I look forward to the book.

Here we go. I'm putting the challenge out to you, Geoff, to do a book because I think you've got amazing, amazing booking you of stories. I think it would just be phenomenal.

I think I'd have to lock myself away for a year in a nice Swedish palette and write it. Hopefully I don't get visited by some crazy woman wanting to break my legs or something like that in that movie. I wouldn't put it past somebody, but, you know, it's like the past is the past, you know.

Yes. Yes. There's a lot to learn from that.

Thank you so much once again, Geoff. Thank you for watching this wherever you are in the world. Hope you have a beautiful day or night and stay tuned.

Check out Ski TV. It's amazing. Some phenomenal content on there and stay tuned for October six and come back and see Geoff present his, you'll be able to ask him questions there as well to do his whole presentation there at the mass media tribe event.

We have a group on Facebook and meetup. You can join and stay posted with details on that. And we'll be covering this topic in more detail, streaming media, the future of global broadcasting.

Thank you so much, Geoff, signing out now. Thank you for watching. Thank you, Belle.

Top scenes, which is thank you very much and see you later from Amsterdam. Thank you. See you later.

Bye. Bye. Bye.

Bye.